Retrieval Hallucination Attribution

Query: How many bronze medals did Sweden win at the 1956 Summer Olympics?
Answer: 6

Agent Trajectory

(Claude-4.5-Sonnet) Answer:

Hallucination Judgment: **YES**
Responsible Step: **4**
Causual Explanation: The agent concluded that Sweden did not win any bronze medals at the 1956 Summer Olympics based on a search result snippet. However, this conclusion is incorrect. According to historical Olympic records, Sweden won 6 bronze medals at the 1956 Summer Olympics. The search result snippet appears to have been misinterpreted or was inaccurate.

Ground Truth:

Hallucination Judgment: **YES**
Responsible Step: **3**
Causual Explanation: The hallucination occurred in Step 3 because the agent relied on a misleading search engine snippet claiming Sweden won no bronze medals, instead of verifying the official medal table, leading to an incorrect conclusion.

Analysis:

The model correctly identifies the hallucination but misattributes its cause, assigning responsibility to the final response step rather than the earlier retrieval step. This failure arises from conflating error manifestation with error origin. The model focuses on the step that verbalizes the incorrect conclusion, without tracing the causal chain back to the retrieval decision that injected unverified evidence into the agent state.